
MAKE STUFF PEOPLE WANT TO WATCH.

How to film it, what to film, and how to
open every video so people stop scrolling.

Mostly pictures.

About 10 minutes to read.

keep this on your phone

IF YOU ONLY READ ONE PAGE

1 THINK IN FORMATS

Don't ask "how do I go viral." Pick a format from this playbook and fill it in.

2 ONLY SCRIPT THE HOOK

The first 3 seconds get written down. Everything after that, you just talk.

3 POST EVERY REEL AS A TRIAL REEL

On Instagram, no exceptions. It's the only way strangers see you first.

4 MIC ON. FACE THE WINDOW.

Good sound and soft light beat an expensive camera every time.

WHAT "VIRAL" ACTUALLY MEANS

1,000,000+ views **and** people actually reacted.
Views alone don't count.



NOT VIRAL

1M views

200 likes

0.02% liked it. Wrong
people saw it, nobody
cared.



VIRAL

1M views

40,000 likes

4% liked it. People watched,
felt something, and acted.

ON 1M VIEWS, AIM FOR	NUMBER	RATE
Likes	30,000+	3%+
Shares	5,000+	0.5%+
Saves	5,000+	0.5%+
Comments	1,000+	0.1%+

Quick check on any video: likes ÷ views.
Under 1% = it didn't land. 3%+ = it hit.

THE KIT

Audio matters more than the camera. People forgive a so-so picture. They scroll past bad sound.



BARE MINIMUM

PHONE + DJI MIC MINI

Prop the phone against anything. A tripod with a phone holder is nice, not needed.



THE UPGRADE

DJI MIC 3

Two clip-on mics + receiver. Plugs into your phone. This is the one to own.



BEST ALL-AROUND

DJI OSMO POCKET 3 + DJI MIC 3

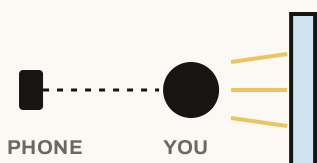
Best camera for this, no questions asked. Pair it with the mic and a window.

no budget for a light? Use a window. Next page.

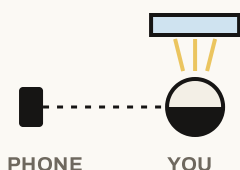
FACE THE WINDOW

Natural light, always, if you can get it. Big window, sun coming in. **No harsh shadows. Ever.**

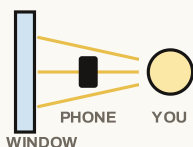
Seen from above:



✗ WINDOW BEHIND YOU
You turn into a dark silhouette.



✗ WINDOW TO THE SIDE
Half your face in shadow. Harsh.



✓ FACING THE WINDOW
Phone between you and the glass. Soft, even light.

The full setup: stand by the window, set up the Pocket 3 (or phone), clip the mic on, turn it on. Done.

THE FIRST 3 SECONDS DECIDE

Give people a reason to care before they scroll.
These are the hooks that work. Fill in the blanks.

Shock

"What it's like to live alone in your parents' attic"

Tutorial

"This is why you should always do ___ before ___"

Comprehensive

"This is every way to do ___"

Common mistake

"I see so many people do ___ like ___. Don't."

Comparison

"There are way too many ___ and they all look the same. But are they?"

Question

"Have you ever seen ___?"

Negative

THE ONE TO MASTER

"Never do ___"

Adding a negative hook has produced some level of virality on every video I've tried it on. Next page shows how to make one on command.

MAKE A NEGATIVE HOOK ON DEMAND

It's a formula. Pick one from each box.

NUMBER

3 · 5
7 · 10

+

NEGATIVE

things you should
never do
mistakes that ruin
stop doing

+

WHAT THEY
WANT

if you want to ____
before you ____
as a ____

**5 THINGS YOU SHOULD NEVER DO IF
YOU WANT TO GET RICH**

made up on the spot. That's the point.

MORE EXAMPLES

"Never do cardio before you lift."

"Don't sign a lease until you watch this."

"3 hires that will kill your small business."

"Stop posting on Instagram like this."

DAILY DRILL · 5 MINUTES

Write 10 negative hooks about your space. Read them out loud. Film the one that makes you go "wait, what?" It feels forced at first. After a few weeks you'll do it in your head.

HOW YOU SAY IT CHANGES IT

Same sentence. Stress a different word and it means something else.

SAY IT LIKE	THEY HEAR
I didn't hit his wife.	Someone else did.
I didn't hit his wife.	Flat denial.
I didn't hit his wife.	I did something else to her.
I didn't hit his wife.	I hit somebody else's wife.
I didn't hit his wife .	I hit someone else of his.

PAUSE BEFORE THE BIG PART

"There's something
(*pause*) I really have to tell
you."

Don't speed-run it.

UNDER 3 SECONDS

Say your hook out loud
with a timer. Over 3
seconds? Cut words.

TALK THE INSTANT YOU HIT RECORD

TikTok starts recording a beat late. If you wait, then talk, the video opens on dead air, and dead air gets scrolled.

PICK A FORMAT

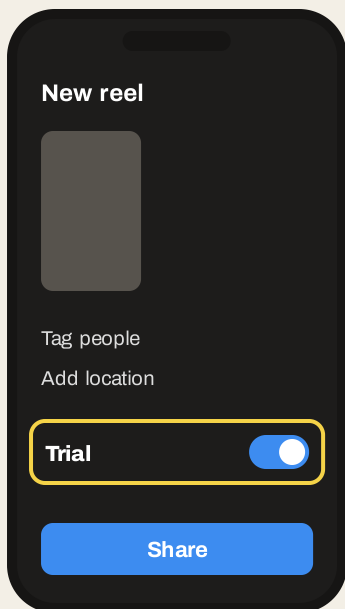
Do you talk? Do you need someone else there?
Everything in a **green box** you can film alone,
today.

	JUST YOU	+ 1 PERSON
YOU TALK	Green screen Whiteboard Ranking Bad, Better, Best ✂ Follow these people ✂ Two-character skit	Street interview ✂ Hire or Fire Myth vs Truth
NO TALKING	Listicle B-roll + text POV skit Podcast clips	Day in the life ✂

✂ needs an editor No mark = edit it inside TikTok/IG yourself.

EVERYTHING IS A TRIAL REEL

Trial Reels get shown to people who **don't** follow you. That's who makes a video go viral. If it's not a Trial Reel, it's not going to work.



← *turn this on.
every single time.*

It's on the last screen before you hit Share.

ACCOUNT DEAD OR BOUGHT?

Start a fresh one. Spend the first few days scrolling and engaging in your space (follow, like, comment), make a few posts, *then* start posting Trial Reels.

FIND THE STORY

Something big just happened in your space. You explain it with the headline behind you.



When?

Hours ago = fresh and hot. Days ago = late.

Who?

Big outlets covering it = big story.

Both?

Film it today.

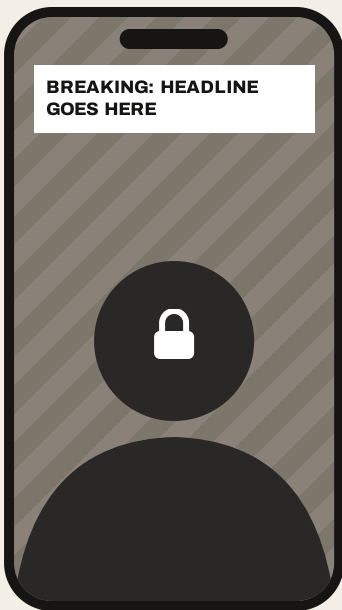
1 Google your topic, tap **News**. Or check **Google Trends** → **Trending now**.

2 Open the stories. **Screenshot** the headline and photos.

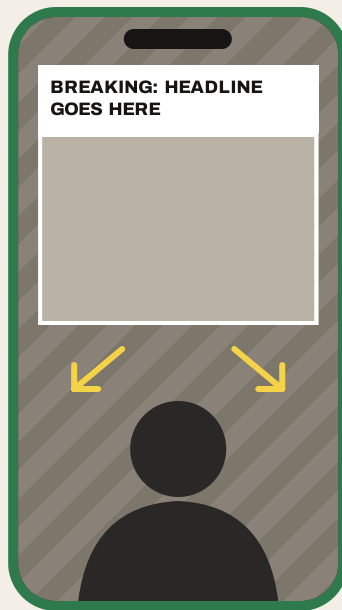
SET IT UP IN TIKTOK

- 1 Open TikTok, tap **+**. Swipe to **10m** if you have it (otherwise 60s).
- 2 Bottom left, tap **Effects**. Search "**Green screen.**"
- 3 Pick the **photo** version, not video, and drop in your screenshot.

There are two kinds. Use the one where you can move yourself.



 **LOCKED IN PLACE**
You cover the image.



 **PINCH TO RESIZE**
Shrink yourself. Image shows.

FILM IT

BEFORE YOU HIT RECORD

- ✓ Mic plugged in, on
- ✓ Facing the window
- ✓ Headline image behind you
- ✓ Negative hook ready

No script after the hook. Just hit these, in order:

- **0-3 SEC**
Hook. Negative, with emphasis, into the lens.
- What happened
- Why it matters to the viewer
- A couple of interesting facts
Swap in other screenshots or B-roll here.
- Your opinion
- Call to action
"Follow for more on ____."



0s

TOTAL: 37-42 SECONDS

THE SAFE ZONE

The app's buttons and captions sit on top of your video. Anything under them is hidden.



Top

For You / Following tabs.

Right side

Profile, like, comment, save, share.

Bottom quarter

Your name, caption, sound.

Left edge

Small margin.

Your face, text, captions and images stay **inside the dashed box**. B-roll can fill the whole screen.

COLLECT B-ROLL EVERY DAY

Film your day on purpose, knowing text will go on top later.

- 1 Open the camera, **tap the screen**, drag the sun **down slightly**. A little darker looks better and text reads easier.
- 2 Leave the **top or middle empty**. That's where text goes.



✗ TOO BUSY



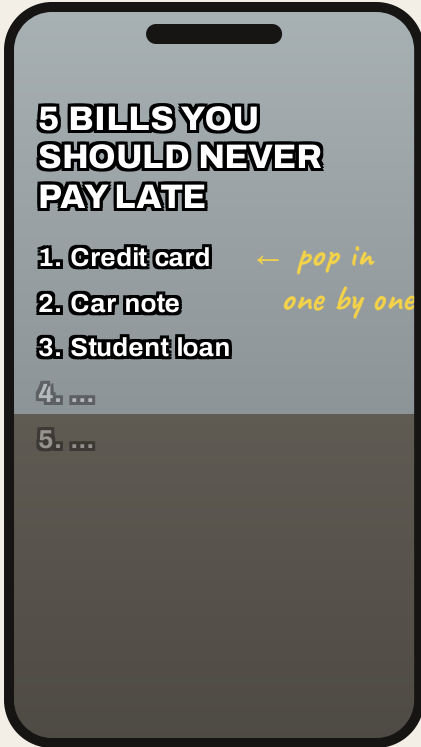
✓ ROOM UP TOP

**TEXT LOOKS
LIKE THIS**

Sans-serif font
White text, black outline
Done in-app

LISTICLE

A headline, then a list that pops up one line at a time over a clip.



MAKE ITEMS POP IN

Tap a line of text → **Set duration**

→ drag with your finger so it starts a beat after the last one.

PICKING THE CLIP

Two jobs:

1. Shows the feeling you want.
2. Calm enough that the text is easy to read.

If the background is busy, the viewer's brain is reading two things at once. They get confused and scroll.

WHITEBOARD & RANKING

WHITEBOARD

Stand at a whiteboard and explain one thing your audience relates to. Draw while you talk. Same hook rules apply.

RANKING: PUT YOUR SPACE ON A TIER LIST

S	
A	
B	
C	
D	people will fight you on this one. good.

WHAT TO RANK

Software

Apps

Influencers

Gurus

Brands

Biggest companies

Celebrities

Styles

Products

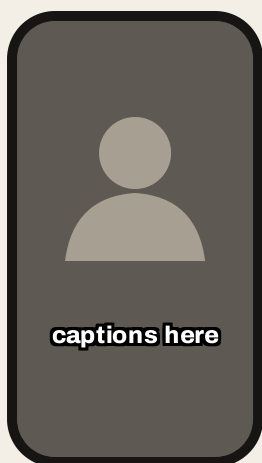
Local spots

Anything in your space. Example that went viral locally: "It's Ranking", ranking Savannah.

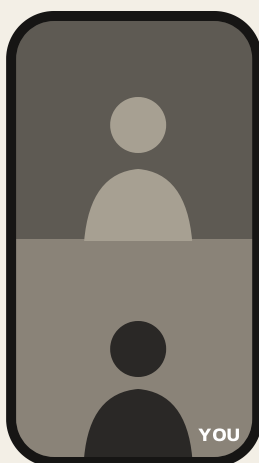
BORROW CREDIBILITY

Clip a famous person in your space from a podcast. Post it as a Trial Reel. This is where to start. It's the closest thing to guaranteed views.

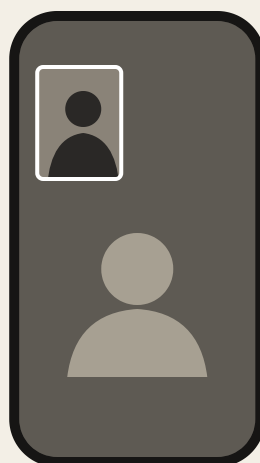
- 1 Watch their podcast. Find one strong moment.
- 2 Screen record it, trim it, add captions in TikTok.



CLIP ONLY



SPLIT SCREEN



CORNER REACTION

TIKTOK CAPTION SETTINGS

1. Turn **punctuation off**.
2. Custom font? Scroll down to **Word switch** (one word at a time).
3. Want no outline? Select the text, tap **Ø**. That gives you plain white text.

TWO KINDS OF SKITS

1 - POV SKIT

usually no talking

"POV: YOUR MANAGER IS WATCHING"

Think of a frustration everyone's had. Act it out and **exaggerate it** until it's funny. No crew needed, but it takes creativity. Stuck? Ask ChatGPT for relatable situations.

Honest take: not the best fit for most business accounts.

2 - TWO-CHARACTER SKIT

talking · you play both

One character is the official (cop, gate agent, clerk). The other is a regular person who knows the rules. The useful info comes out **inside the conversation**, never said to the camera.

GATE AGENT

"Your flight's cancelled. Best I can do is tomorrow."

YOU

"If I don't take the rebooking, I'm owed a full cash refund, right? Not a voucher."

GATE AGENT

"...Let me process that."

Works for: tickets, citations, landlords, the DMV, contracts.

ALGO HACKS

Short, repeatable, and they convert followers.
Bad, Better, Best was the go-to.

BAD, BETTER, BEST

Look up. Point left: "Bad."
Middle: "Better." Right: "Best."
Three times. Then to camera:
"Follow for more."

"FOLLOW THESE PEOPLE"

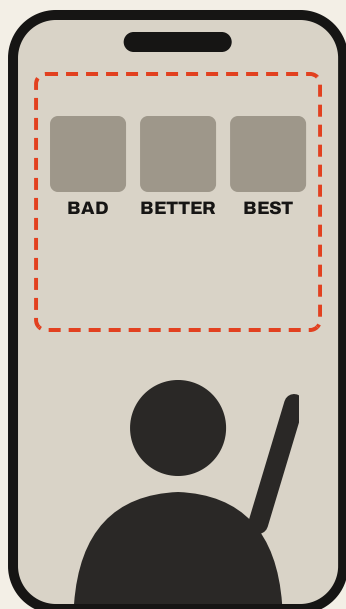
"If you suck at reading..." point up "...follow these people."
Repeat with money, AI, listening.

HIRE OR FIRE

Someone off camera with a mic reads a work situation. You answer: "Hire." or "Fire."

MYTH OR TRUTH

Someone off camera reads a statement. You answer: "Myth." or "Truth."



FRAME IT LOW

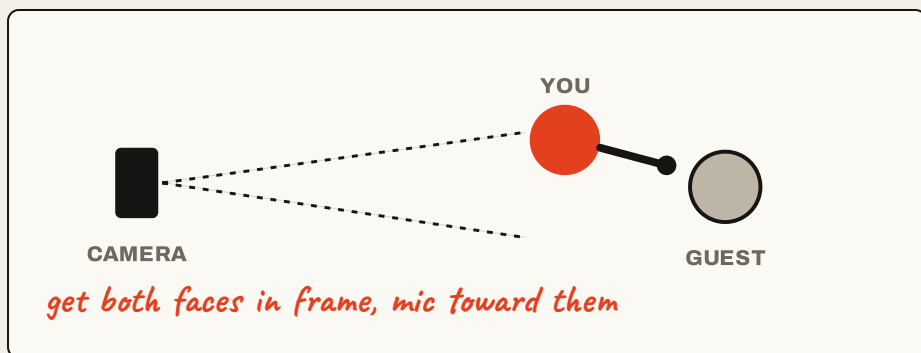
You sit in the bottom half. Leave the top empty so the images pop up above your head without getting cut off. Good light, always.

Images over your head are the one part an editor helps with.

STREET INTERVIEW

One person holds the mic, one person films. Street, gym, anywhere people are. Takes the most courage. Here's the exact script so it doesn't feel weird.

- 1 Walk up: **"Hey, question for you. Would you be opposed to being in a TikTok? We do ____."**
- 2 If yes: **"Cool. Pretend you don't know me."**
- 3 Walk away.
- 4 Camera person hits record.
- 5 Walk back up and start the video like it's the first time.



Your first question is your hook. Make it something people have an opinion on. Same 3-second rule.

SKIP THESE



REACTION / REMIX

The built-in Instagram feature. Zero views every time I've tried it. (Reacting inside your own edit, like on the borrowed credibility page, is different.)



MOCKCAST

Fake podcast set. Needs a camera person and pro lighting. Never seen it work.

EVERY DAY



Film B-roll of your day



Write 10 negative hooks



Post at least one video (Trial Reel on IG)



Check yesterday's likes ÷ views

NOBODY REALLY KNOWS WHAT PEOPLE WANT TO WATCH. THE PEOPLE WHO WIN JUST TEST MORE.